Renzo Damian

Data/AI Engineer | Lima, Peru | renzo.damian.go@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/renzo-damian | renzodamian.com

Summary

Data/AI Engineer with an M.S. in Advanced Computer Science (With Merit) from the University of Sheffield and software development experience in banking and HR data since 2021. Build Python and SQL data pipelines and machine learning models (classification, embeddings, deep learning) over large datasets, evaluate them against ground truth, and turn the results into decisions for product and business teams.

Skills

Data: Python, SQL (PostgreSQL, SQL Server, Oracle), pandas, NumPy, data pipelines, data quality validation, pytest
Machine Learning: scikit-learn, PyTorch (training and evaluation), embeddings (sentence-transformers), LLM APIs, OCR with self-hosted models (vLLM), evaluation against ground truth
Backend & Tools: NestJS, Spring Boot, REST APIs, Docker, Git, Agile/Scrum

Work Experience

Mandü HR (Visma LatAm) Lima, PE
Data/AI Engineer *Aug 2026 – Present*

- Built a Python and PostgreSQL pipeline that automatically extracts, validates, and classifies a raw, mixed HR database, turning it into clean, normalized data ready for dashboards, AI agents, and other uses
- Within the pipeline, normalized and classified 20k+ job titles, each company writing them differently, into a standard taxonomy using text normalization rules, JobBERT-v3 embeddings, and batched LLM calls
- Built a NestJS REST API that delivers the processed data to client dashboards
- Built an OCR system with self-hosted open models for secure extraction of sensitive data, validated against ground truth on key fields, at about 5x lower cost than commercial OCR APIs

Bevertec Lima, PE
Full Stack Java Developer (banking sector) *Sep 2022 – Sep 2023*

- Rewrote slow Oracle SQL queries behind internal reports, cutting load time by 50% (8s to 4s)
- Built RESTful APIs in Spring Boot for a platform with 10,000+ daily users, including endpoints for user permissions and data retrieval
- Built Groovy/Grails MVC features in 2-week Agile sprints with design and QA teams

Education

University of Sheffield Sheffield, UK
M.S. in Advanced Computer Science, ***With Merit*** *Sep 2024 – Oct 2025*
Universidad Peruana de Ciencias Aplicadas (UPC) Lima, PE
B.S. in Computer Science, GPA: 3.5/4.0 *Jan 2018 – Jul 2023*

- **Concentrations**: Machine Learning & Computer Vision. Honor Scholarship (top 10% of students, 2021)

Projects and Leadership

- **Multi-Target Speaker Extraction (M.S. Dissertation)**: Trained and evaluated a deep learning model in PyTorch for the CHiME-9 ECHI Challenge, separating multiple target speakers from noisy audio
- **DriveSafe – Driver Drowsiness Detection (B.S. Dissertation)**: Trained a YOLOv8 model on a custom dataset and deployed it in an iOS app with Core ML, running on-device at 68 fps
- **Project MarsWorks, University of Sheffield (Software Team Lead, 2024–2025)**: Led a 6-person software team within a 50+ student project building Mars rovers for the Anatolian Rover Challenge (Turkey), designing autonomous navigation with ROS2 and Nav2
- **Robotek (Robotics Coach, 2024–Present)**: Coached a student team in computer vision and PID control for an autonomous car, reaching 2nd Place at WRO Peru and 3rd Place at the WRO Open Championship Americas (2024)

Certifications and Languages

- **Deep Learning Specialization (Oct 2026)**: DeepLearning.AI (Coursera)
- **Learn SQL Basics for Data Science Specialization**: University of California, Davis
- **Machine Learning with TensorFlow on Google Cloud**: Google Cloud
- **Languages**: Spanish (native), English (C2 Proficient – EF SET 82/100)